

Taylor Tokos

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taylortokos.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science, University of Iowa 2027 (expected)

Dissertation: “Strategic Representation through Bill Complexity: How Legislators Use Technical and Structural Complexity in Policymaking.”

Chair: Frederick J. Boehmke

Committee Members: Tracy Osborn, Colin Case, Justin Kirkland

M.A., Political Science, University of Iowa 2023

B.A., Political Science, Creighton University, Omaha, NE 2021

RESEARCH & TEACHING INTERESTS

American Politics

Legislative Studies, State Politics, Women and Politics, Representation, Policymaking

Methodology

Statistical Modeling, Data Visualization, Text Analysis, Data Management, Computational Social Science

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Coll, Joseph A., Rachel S. Torres, and **Taylor Tokos**. 2026. “The Electoral Race Card: How Racially Coded Claims of Voter Fraud Reduce Voter Confidence among Racially Polarized White Americans.” *Politics and Governance*, 14. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.17645/pag.11587>.

Boehmke, Frederick J., Thomas Dainty, Samantha J. DeRagon, Hyein Ko, **Taylor Tokos**, Tianhui Wu, and Weidong Zhang. “The Use of Data Visualization in Political Science.” *PS: Political Science and Politics*.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Tokos, Taylor. “The Substance and Style of Lawmaking Linguistic and Compositional Bill Complexity in the U.S. House, 1993–2025.” *Journal of Politics*.

Boehmke, Frederick J., Bruce A. Desmarais, Jeffrey J. Harden, Samuel Harper, Hyein Ko, Johabed Olvera, Isaac Pollert, Tracee Saunders, and **Taylor Tokos**. “Uncertainty, Heuristics, and the Malleability of Public Policy Diffusion.” *American Journal of Political Science*.

WORKING PAPERS

Tokos, Taylor. “Linguistic and Compositional Bill Complexity in the U.S. States.”

Tokos, Taylor and Frederick J. Boehmke. “Improving Analysis of Legislative Effectiveness Scores.”

Tokos, Taylor, Caroline Tolbert, and Richard Witmer. “Native American Voter Turnout: The Impact of Election Laws and Administrative Capacity.”

Osborn, Tracy, Anna Mahoney, Brody DeBettignies, **Taylor Tokos**, and Olive Kuester. “Party Power: Understanding Women Legislators’ Status within Parties in the State Legislatures.”

Boehmke, Frederick J., Bruce A. Desmarais, Jeffrey J. Harden, Samuel Harper, Hyein Ko, Taegyeon Kim, Johabed Olvera, Isaac Pollert, Tracee Saunders, and **Taylor Tokos**. “Diffusion in a Time of Uncertainty: How the Determinants of State Policy Choices Changed During the Pandemic.”

Boehmke, Frederick J., Bruce A. Desmarais, Jeffrey J. Harden, Hyein Ko, Johabed Olvera, Tracee Saunders, and **Taylor Tokos**. “The Evolution of State Policy Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic.”

Boehmke, Frederick J., Bruce A. Desmarais, Jeffrey J. Harden, Samuel F. Harper, Hyein Ko, Tracee Saunders, and **Taylor Tokos**. “Lessons About State Policy Responses to COVID-19 Through Data Visualization.”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Primary Instructor, University of Iowa Spring 2026
POLI 1100: Introduction to American Politics (40 students)

Guest Lecturer, University of Iowa Fall 2024
POLI 7003: Advanced Methodology
Gave a lecture on data visualization to second year Ph.D. students in the Advanced methodology class. This lecture included creating maps, descriptive data visualizations, and post-estimation visualizations.

Teaching Assistant, University of Iowa Spring 2023
POLI 1501: Introduction to American Foreign Policy

Teaching Assistant, University of Iowa Fall 2022
POLI 1100: Introduction to American Politics

Primary Instructor, University of Iowa Fall 2022
POLI 1100: Introduction to American Politics (Online)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Frederick J. Boehmke Fall 2023-Spring 2026
Research Assistant, Colin R. Case Summer 2025; Fall 2026
Research Assistant, Tracy Osborn Summer 2023
Research Assistant, Caroline J. Tolbert Summer 2023

AWARDS AND GRANTS

Institute for Public Policy and Social Research Travel Grant (\$750) 2026
Awarded to a select number of PolMeth 2026 conference attendees.

Tom Carsey Graduate Fellow (\$300) 2026
Awarded travel grant to attend the 2026 State Politics and Policy Conference.

Graduate College Summer Fellowship (\$5,500) 2026

WORKSHOPS AND PRESENTATIONS

Department of Political Science Methods Workshop Spring 2026
“Improving Analysis of Legislative Effectiveness Scores.”

Department of Political Science American Politics Workshop Spring 2026
“Linguistic and Compositional Complexity in the U.S. House.”

Department of Political Science Methods Workshop Fall 2025
“The Use of Data Visualization in Political Science.”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- “Improving Analysis of Legislative Effectiveness Scores.”
SPPC 2026, Chicago, IL
- “The Substance and Style of Lawmaking: Linguistic and Compositional Complexity in the U.S. House.”
MPSA 2026, Chicago, IL
- “Bill Complexity in the U.S. House of Representatives from 1993-2025.”
WiLS 2025, Champaign, IL
- “Party Power: Understanding Women Legislators’ Status within Parties in the State Legislatures.”
WiLS 2025, Champaign, IL
- “The Heterogeneous Effect of State Ideology on State Policy Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic.”
SPPC 2025, Boston, MA
- “State Policy Responses to COVID-19: 8 Takeaways Through Visualizations.”
MPSA 2025, Chicago, IL
- “The Evolution of State Policy Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic.”
MPSA 2025, Chicago, IL
- “The Use of Data Visualization in Political Science.”
MPSA 2025, Chicago, IL
- “Native American Voter Turnout: The Impact of Voting Laws and Election Administrative Capacity.”
MPSA 2024, Chicago, IL
- “A Comprehensive Look at State Policy Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic”
MPSA 2024, Chicago, IL
- “Native American Voter Turnout: The Impact of Voting Laws and Election Administrative Capacity.”
ESRA 2024, Los Angeles, CA
- “American Indian Turnout and Election Law Change.”
MPSA 2022, Chicago, IL

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Stata Workshop Instructor**, University of Iowa Spring 2024
Taught a workshop to first-year Ph.D. students. This workshop introduces graduate students to coding in Stata, and covers topics ranging from data management, exploration, and visualization.
- Peer Mentor**, Iowa Graduate Association of Political Scientists 2023-2024

AFFILIATIONS

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| Midwest Political Science Association | 2021 - Present |
| Women in Legislative Studies | 2024 - Present |
| The Society for Political Methodology | 2025 - Present |
| American Political Science Association | 2025 - Present |

SKILLS

- Programming Languages**
Stata, R, LaTeX, Qualtrics

REFERENCES

Frederick J. Boehmke
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University of Iowa
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Associate Professor
University of Iowa
(319) 335-2337
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